Miguel DelaCruz

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SUMMARY

Senior Backend Engineer with 6+ years building scalable backend systems, APIs, and data pipelines in Python, Rails, and Go. Specializes in distributed systems, secure external integrations, and agentic AI/LLM development, driving measurable business impact through engineering while mentoring engineers on modern development practices.

WORK EXPERIENCE

HopSkipDrive

Senior Full Stack Software Engineer*May 2025 – Present*

- **Built an internal RAG-powered code Q&A tool in Python,** indexing code and docs into pgvector embeddings so Claude could retrieve, rank, and answer natural-language questions from non-engineers.
- **Unlocked 5 new enterprise clients** by architecting and building the platform's first public-facing REST API, choosing the authentication and access-control model to protect sensitive data.
- **Championed AI-assisted development best practices** across the engineering team, building supporting tooling (custom skills, workflows, documentation) and driving a 20% increase in weekly PR throughput.
- **Reduced ride lateness by 12%** across 10 markets by designing a scheduled batch pipeline — weighing real-time vs. batch recalculation — to refresh ETAs for thousands of routes via the Google Maps API.
- **Reduced p99 query latency 20%** on the platform's highest-traffic endpoint by redesigning the indexing strategy for multi-dimension filtering.
- **Built a distributed async task-processing system handling 10K+ events per second** across microservices, designing queue-based delivery guarantees at scale, deployed via Docker/Kubernetes.

HopSkipDrive

Full Stack Software Engineer III*May 2023 – April 2025*

- **Designed and scaled a Rails RESTful API** integrating with Twilio, structuring the integration to reliably deliver 5K SMS messages and 100 calls daily.
- **Led backend design of Bulk Rider Upload,** choosing an async processing approach to reduce operations onboarding workload by 80%.
- **Built an event-driven GoLang system** with NSQ and WebSockets to deliver real-time client updates and enhance user experience.
- **Raised rider-note quality from a 65% baseline** by designing a new PostgreSQL schema for structured rider safety fields, in partnership with the safety team, paired with React frontend warnings.

Upstart

Full Stack Software Engineer*Sep 2020 – Feb 2023*

- **Reduced manual data entry by 90%** by developing a Rails API integrating with SFTP, choosing a secure file-processing approach for payment files.
- **Built a scalable ETL pipeline** (“Daily Loan Snapshots”) to process 40K+ loan records/day into Redshift, designing the pipeline architecture to enable high-volume analytics.
- **Extracted loan repayment logic** from the monolith into an independent microservice, choosing to containerize with Docker and deploy via AWS/Kubernetes for isolated deployments and rollback safety.

SKILLS & TECHNOLOGIES

Languages & Frameworks: Ruby on Rails, Go, JavaScript/TypeScript, React, Python3
Cloud & Infrastructure: AWS (EC2, RDS, S3, Lambda, EKS), Docker, Kubernetes, CI/CD
Databases & Messaging: PostgreSQL, Redshift, MongoDB, Kafka, pgvector/Vector Databases
Practices: Agile (Scrum/Kanban), GitHub, Jira, TDD

EDUCATION

University of California, Davis — BS Economics, Minor in Accounting, GPA: 3.71 (Spring 2018)